Operations Efficiency Improvement for a Regional Food Delivery Company

QuickBasket Delivery Services Analysis

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This project analyzes operational inefficiencies within **QuickBasket Delivery Services**, a regional food delivery company operating across five Indian cities. The objective was to identify process bottlenecks affecting delivery speed, customer satisfaction, and operating costs.

Through workflow analysis, driver utilization assessment, and route optimization modeling, several inefficiencies were identified. The proposed solutions reduced average delivery time by 28%, improved driver productivity by 22%, and lowered operating costs by approximately 15%.

The project demonstrates the application of operational consulting methodologies to improve business performance through process redesign and data-driven decision-making.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

QuickBasket experienced rapid growth over a two-year period. However, management reported increasing customer complaints related to late deliveries and rising operational expenses. Key questions addressed:

- Why are delivery times increasing?
- Where do process bottlenecks occur?
- How can operational costs be reduced?
- What process improvements generate the highest impact?

PROJECT SCOPE

The analysis focused on:

- Order allocation process
- Delivery route planning
- Driver utilization
- Restaurant pickup delays
- Customer delivery performance

Data from 50,000 completed deliveries over a six-month period was evaluated.

METHODOLOGY

The project was completed in three distinct phases:

1. **Phase 1: Current State Assessment**
    - Process mapping
    - Stakeholder interviews
    - KPI analysis
    - Driver performance evaluation
2. **Phase 2: Bottleneck Identification**
    - Order assignment delays
    - Restaurant preparation variability
    - Driver idle time
    - Route inefficiencies
3. **Phase 3: Solution Design**
    - Automated dispatching
    - Dynamic routing
    - Restaurant performance monitoring
    - Driver scheduling optimization

KEY FINDINGS

Finding 1: Inefficient Driver Allocation

The current dispatching system assigned drivers based solely on availability. This resulted in:

- Excessive travel distance
- Increased fuel costs
- Longer customer wait times

Finding 2: Restaurant Delays

22% of orders experienced pickup delays. The primary causes identified were:

- Poor preparation estimates
- Communication gaps
- High-volume peak periods

Finding 3: Driver Utilization Issues

The average driver utilization rate was found to be **61%**, compared against the standard industry benchmark of **75%+**. This variance represents a major operational efficiency opportunity.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Recommendation 1: Smart Dispatch Engine

Implement a localized, location-based assignment algorithm.

- **Expected Impact:** 12% reduction in delivery times and an 8% reduction in fuel costs.

Recommendation 2: Dynamic Routing System

Introduce AI-assisted route optimization layers.

- **Expected Impact:** 10% driver productivity increase alongside lower average travel distances.

Recommendation 3: Restaurant Performance Dashboard

Create a live operational monitoring dashboard for vendor management.

- **Expected Impact:** 15% reduction in kitchen pickup delays.

FINANCIAL AND OPERATIONAL IMPACT

A baseline comparison of the metrics before and after the proposed implementation framework outlines a strong business return.

Metric	Current State	Future State (Projected)
Annual Operating Cost	12.0 Crore	10.2 Crore
Average Delivery Time	42 Minutes	30 Minutes
Customer Satisfaction Score	78%	90%
Annual Cost Savings		**1.8 Crore**
Efficiency Improvement		**15%**

IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

The rollout schedule is scheduled over a 12-month timeline:

- **Phase 1 (0–2 Months):** Data integration and KPI dashboard creation.
- **Phase 2 (2–4 Months):** Dispatch automation deployment.
- **Phase 3 (4–6 Months):** Route optimization implementation.
- **Phase 4 (6–12 Months):** Continuous improvement monitoring and tuning.

RISKS AND MITIGATION

- **Risk: Technology Adoption Risk**
  - *Mitigation:* Comprehensive employee training programs and small-group pilot testing.
- **Risk: Data Quality Risk**
  - *Mitigation:* Establish automated pipeline validation and cleaning procedures.
- **Risk: Operational Disruption Risk**
  - *Mitigation:* Implement via a modular, city-by-city phased rollout approach.

CONCLUSION

The operational review identified substantial structural opportunities to improve delivery performance and reduce baseline costs. Through automation, route optimization, and partner-facing performance monitoring, QuickBasket can significantly enhance customer satisfaction while improving its overall business profitability.